



Listen & Play

Sound Healing Workshop

What is Sound Healing?

Sound Healing is the specific use of frequencies to promote healing and balance. Sound can have profound effects on our health and wellbeing, whether we actively listen to music, play an instrument, move to the beat of the music or receive beneficial frequencies in a passive way. It addresses various planes of our existence, from the physical to the emotional and spiritual level by using different instruments and the voice. In a way, it helps us to be more 'in tune' with ourselves and 'in sync' with the natural laws, structure and order of the cosmos. In general, Sound Healing therapy is based on the principle all of life is vibration, including our own bodies. When our resonant frequency is out of balance, physical and emotional health is affected.

Brief History and of Sound Healing and its Use

The power of sound to heal was used by most ancient cultures. To name a few, the ancient Greeks were using the flute and lyre, Native Americans have been using shamanic drums and songs, Aborigines of Australia have been playing the didgeridoo and Hindus of India have been chanting Sanskrit mantras to restore balance, harmony and health within people, communities and nature. Healing with sound has been rediscovered in the last century and is gaining more and more acknowledgement from scientists and popularity among people from various ages and backgrounds. As an example, music therapy was offered for wounded soldiers of the Second World War and Ultrasound was successfully introduced into Western medicine e.g. to dissolve kidney stones, reduce tumours and evaluate the condition of internal organs and soft tissues.

New Science based on Ancient Beliefs

Since a few decades, scientists are more and more interested in finding out how Sound Healing works and how it can be used to treat various illnesses, in conjunction with allopathic medicine or even as a stand-alone treatment. Edgar Cayce predicted that "Sound is the medicine of the future." Science is rapidly evolving and it will be fascinating to witness new findings about the healing power of sound.

Ancient people already knew that **everything is vibration** and even Einstein found this to be true as he supposedly said "Everything is energy and that's all there is to it. Match the frequency of the reality you want and you cannot help but get that reality. It can be no other way. This is not philosophy. This is physics." Since the rise of Quantum Physics that aims to

explain the model of reality and existence from the micro to the macrocosm, we experience a huge paradigm shift.

The previous split of spirituality and science, the disconnection of body and mind seems to slowly disintegrate, to be replaced with not only the belief, but with scientific evidence that everything and everyone is interconnected in a sea of vibration.

How Sound Healing Works

Sound is continuous and regular vibration that travels through air and other mediums. The **frequency** of a sound is the speed of the vibration per second, measured in Hertz. For humans, audible sounds are between 20 and 20.000 Hz. When sound reaches our ears, it travels up the auditory nerve into our brain where it is processed. Sounds then can trigger **bodily responses** by changing brain chemicals, e.g. to alter our heart rate, blood pressure, emotional state or muscle tension.

Sound not only travels through air, it even travels faster through water and much faster through bone. Knowing that our bodies are made up of about 70% water, we realize the **potency of sound** vibrations that go straight to all cells of our body. Our body as a whole is a sensory organ, which means we do not only hear the sounds with our ears but feel them through all of our tissues.

Sound affects us on so many different levels, from the cellular function to the tissues, hormones, brain waves and the flow of energy in our body. Sound does not only work within the body, but also on the aura, the bioelectrical field around the body which can be harmonized with sound.

Our body has a natural inclination to heal itself, to recreate order, balance and harmony. It seeks **homeostasis** and wants to be ‘**in tune**’, but many factors can hinder this natural process such as pollutants and toxins, lifestyle, stress, diet, lack of movement or mind state. Deepak Chopra states that “The body is held together by sound and the presence of disease indicates that some sounds are out of tune.” Mitchell Gaynor, a physician who worked with sound healing as complementary treatment for cancer patients said “You can look at disease as a form of disharmony. And there’s no organ system in the body that’s not affected by sound and music and vibration.”

Sound can act as a medium for our bodies to heal themselves through **entrainment**. When the sound healer introduces beneficial frequencies during the sound therapy, the body gets a signal to move towards this frequency and match the ‘healthy’ sound vibration. Natural, primordial sounds are much more effective in doing so, as they represent the inherent harmonious order of nature versus electronic music, which creates only a shorter and lower effect of entrainment.

The intention that we put into the sound healing sessions (both as a giver and as a receiver) are as important as the frequencies themselves. Jonathan Goldman, a pioneer of the recent rise in Sound Healing created the formula “**Frequency + Intention = Healing**”. Thoughts can be seen as a form of energy and as we add beneficial, health-promoting, heart-centred intention into the process, the results of the sound healing are magnified.

“Each celestial body in fact each and every atom, produces a particular sound on account of its movement, its rhythm or vibration. All these sounds and vibrations form a universal harmony in

which each element, while having its own function and character, contributes to the whole.”
Pythagoras (569-475 BC)

The Benefits of Sound Healing

Sound is known as one of the most natural forms of healing known to mankind. Some cultures have long realised that the beneficial effects of sound go much deeper than just relaxation. Sound healing touches us on so many different levels: physical, energetic, emotional, mental and spiritual.

The effects of sound healing may include:

- stress reduction
- emotional balance
- lowered blood pressure
- soothing the nervous system
- improved sleep
- muscle relaxation
- more coherence in the brain waves
- deepening meditative states, calming the mind
- pain relief
- inducing higher states of consciousness

Instruments of Sound Healing

Sound Healers use an array of instruments for healing, including the human voice. The sounds can be on the lower range of frequencies such as deep gongs, drums or large singing bowls, they can also include higher notes from chimes, flutes or cymbals or any range of frequencies in between. The qualities of the instruments, the material (such as wood or metal) and how they are played can help us to realign with the **elements of earth, water, fire, wind and space**. A fascinating **soundscape** is being created for the listener, as the sounds reach the receiver from various directions and sources.

The **instruments** used in sound healing invite us to explore our connection to the natural elements, the wisdom of ancient cultures and the inherent harmonious order of the cosmos.

- Human voice
- Tibetan Singing Bowls and Crystal Bowls
- Gongs (planetary gongs, Balinese “nipple” gongs)
- Rain makers, Ocean drums, waterphone
- Drums (Shamanic drums, mother drum)
- Wood instruments (bamboo chimes, rattles, shakers)
- Strings (monochord, tanpoora, kecapi, guitar)
- Sruti box & Harmonium
- Flutes (Balinese bamboo flutes, native American flutes, okarina)
- Smaller instruments with higher frequencies (etheric instruments)
(swinging chimes, wind chimes, bells, koshi chimes, tuning forks)

Listen & Play

Sound healing can be a beautiful path of self-exploration - not only receiving sound journeys in a group setting or individual sound baths, but also getting to know the different qualities of various sound healing instruments, learning to play them and creating a relationship with a whole palette of sounds (and silence!).

As we receive and play sounds, we can investigate how they affect our different layers of our being and how the sounds can help us create more harmony and balance (physical, energetic, mental, emotional and spiritual). We can train ourselves to consciously listen (not only with our ears but with our whole body) and feel the vibrations within us and in the energy field around us.

We can express ourselves through sound in various creative and intuitive ways. We also learn to be with and allow in different kinds of sounds in order to create more “harmonious vibes” in our lives.

“Harmony sinks deep into the recesses of the soul and takes its strongest hold there, bringing grace also to the body and mind as well. Music is a moral law. It gives a soul to the universe, wings to the mind, flight to the imagination, a charm to sadness, and life to everything. It is the essence of order.” Plato (429-347)

Questions for Sound Exploration:

- Which sounds do you love?
- Are there sounds that you don't like? Is there a story behind, why?
- Can you relate to the culture where the instrument comes from?
- Can you relate to the element that the instrument may represent?
- Does your preference for certain sounds change from day to day?
- How do certain sounds make you feel?
(e.g., comforting, grounding, relaxed, spacious)?

Elements of Sound

As we dive into the world of sound, we play with various elements, such as:

- Pulse and Rhythm
- Pitch and Melody
- Harmony and Sonic Texture
- Timbre (tone color)
- Drone
- Repetition and Duration of sounds
- Volume and Dynamics
- Form & Structure

How and what to play?

Sound Healing is a very individual journey with no preset rules, yet there are certain guidelines that have been found to be helpful. Various schools of sound healing follow different approaches, from preset protocols of how to play Tibetan Singing Bowls or Gongs to creating a wave like structure for a sound healing session, or to follow a successive order of playing instruments in order to touch the various qualities of the natural elements or to connect to our main energy centers (chakras).

As practitioners, we are part of the process and our own energy, mental-emotional state and level of awareness will influence our sound healing. The most powerful healing can occur when we become **highly intuitive and fully present**.

- Come to a neutral state, become a channel (leaving our personal agenda outside)
- Stay connected to the receiver and the space (not focused on the instruments only, but watch & feel the receiver as you play)
- Focused intention from the heart to amplify the healing power of sound
- Be mindful about the volume (how close can you play certain instruments?
How do the instruments resonate in the room?)
- Strengthen your intuition and ability to deeply listen
- Be mindful and focused (e.g., walking quietly, not tripping over instruments)
- Keep the attitude of service and humility
- Be reminded on the power of silence

Recommended Reading

- “The Healing Power of Sound”, Mitchell L. Gaynor. M.D.
- “The Power of Sound: How to Be Healthy and Productive Using Music and Sound”
Joshua Leeds
- “The Music Lesson”, Victor L. Wooten
- “The Humming Effect”, Jonathan Goldman
and blog articles on his website, e.g.
<https://www.healingsounds.com/sonic-entrainment/>
- “The Ear and the Voice”, Alfred A. Tomatis and Francis Keeping
- “The World Is Sound: Nada Brahma”, Joachim Ernst Berendt
- “The Yoga of Sound: Healing and Enlightenment Through the Sacred Practice of Mantra”,
Russill Paul
- “Healing at the Speed of Sound”, Don Campbell
- “Tuning the Human Biofield”, Eileen McKusick